

Sophie Purewal

Senior UI Designer • Product Design, Design Systems, AI Prototyping, Financial Services • London, UK

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Summary

Senior UI / Product Designer with proven experience designing digital products, scalable design systems and accessible customer experiences within regulated UK financial services. Experienced across product, engineering and stakeholder collaboration, with strengths in design-system governance, UI quality, accessibility, and AI-assisted product development and prototyping. Recently created ChartStudio, an AI-assisted Figma plugin for responsive data visualisation, demonstrating practical use of emerging AI tools to accelerate design-to-code workflows.

Core Skills

Product & UI Design: UI Design, Product Design, Interaction Design, User Flows, Wireframing, Prototyping, Responsive Web, Complex Forms, Design QA, UAT

Design Systems: Figma Libraries, Design Tokens, Reusable UI Patterns, Component Documentation, Governance, WCAG Accessibility, Developer Handoff

Collaboration & Delivery: Stakeholder Workshops, Requirements Gathering, Product and Engineering Collaboration, Design Critique, Presentation, Mentoring

Financial Services & AI: Regulated Journeys, Pensions, Investments, Salary Sacrifice, Customer Communications, OpenAI Codex, AI-Assisted Prototyping, GitHub

Career

Senior UI Designer • Aegon UK • 08/22 to present, London, UK

- Reduced duplicate UI effort and improved cross-team consistency by building, redesigning and modernising reusable Core Components within the Figma design system, supporting 21,000+ Figma-tracked component insertions across header, status, feedback, layout and form patterns over 12 months.
- Improved the usability and clarity of a public-facing salary sacrifice calculator by redesigning a complex financial tool for the Aegon website, helping customers better understand pension contribution options within a regulated environment.
- Improved design-system quality and governance by progressing 15 redesigned Core Components through peer design review, engineering review and release into the shared Figma library.
- Strengthened design capability across the wider team by mentoring five designers through an internal Figma fundamentals course and supporting a graduate designer over 7 months through Figma practice, creative brainstorming and UAT processes.

Founder & Director • Sophie Purewal Design • 07/17 to 08/22 • London, UK

- Founded and operated an independent design studio delivering UI, UX consulting, brand, responsive web, app and digital design work.
- Delivered end-to-end product design from discovery and research through to wireframes, high-fidelity mockups, prototypes, style guides and developer handoff.
- Strengthened client design maturity by introducing clearer design processes, collaboration tools, documented design decisions and handoff practices.

UI Design Mentor • Contract client: CareerFoundry • 08/17 to 08/22 • London, UK

- Mentored students and UX professionals transitioning into UI and Product Design careers through portfolio reviews, structured feedback and design coaching.
- Improved student outcomes through guidance on visual hierarchy, layout, typography, colour, usability, accessibility and prototype quality.
- Edited and rewrote UI for UX course materials, increasing clarity and alignment with current design practice.

UX & UI Designer • Contract client: VLE Support • 06/18 to 10/18 • London, UK

- Led UX consultation and UI design for phase one of the VLE ePlacements web app, a work placement platform designed to help learning providers, students and employers support T-Level placement matching and management.
- Defined core product flows and MVP functionality through collaborative UX research, personas, user flows, low-to-high fidelity wireframes, prototype testing and preference/A/B testing.
- Delivered responsive UI design assets across mobile, tablet and desktop breakpoints, including visual concepts, style guide, grids, typography, iconography, InVision prototype and final screen assets for handoff.

Selected Product Innovation

ChartStudio - AI-Assisted Figma Plugin • 05/26 to present • active development

- Identified a recurring workflow gap for designers creating consistent data visualisations in Figma, then defined and prototyped an AI-assisted plugin supporting responsive bar, line and doughnut charts.
- Defined the product concept, UX, feature requirements, configuration model and visual design system independently.
- Used OpenAI Codex and AI-assisted development workflows to prototype functioning plugin capability, demonstrating practical experience bridging product design and software development.

Certifications

AI Prototyping Camp • Designlab • AI-first prototyping, Prompt to Prototype workflows, Figma Make, Lovable

Certification in Graphic Design • Shillington Education

Graphic Design Short Course • University of the Arts London

BA (Hons) Ancient History and Archaeology • University of Liverpool

Member, Women in Banking and Finance • Leadership Insights on Developing People.